



Figure 1: Guitarix

Comparing Guitarix and Guitar Rig

Connectivity: Both require you to buy a good audio interface with an instrument input. Some people use a normal sound card but this can increase latency at a very high level. Using an audio interface takes away the load of processing sound from the slower inner sound card of the system. Moreover, the interface has the ability to take in the audio signals and balance them so that the modelling is easier.

Focusrite is the most famous brand out there right now because of its reasonable price tags. Steinberg, Behringer, M-Audio, Zoom, etc, are the other readily available good choices. Opt for audio interfaces that provide 24-bit/192kHz audio resolution (this is the audio resolution of FLAC files of most well known albums). This will also reduce the latency while monitoring. This is the standard studio quality; so you can achieve studio quality recording sitting at home. You just have to master some basic techniques.

Latency: Both options provide low latency playback. But in Guitar Rig, sometimes, latency seems a little bit more (< 230ms) than Guitarix (< 100ms). This has to do with the large VSTs used in Guitar Rig and the high latency caused by the Windows OS due to the allocation of the processors for countless background processes. Guitarix VSTs are usually light, and since it runs on Linux systems, it is a bit more efficient in how it works. On Mac systems, both run with virtually no latency.



Figure 2: Guitar Rig

Interface: The user interfaces of both are similar, but Guitarix's is much simpler. Both have adapted the theme of guitar cabinets and knobs. Both look cool but Guitar Rig provides more control, functionality and flexibility to the user. Other than that, both software are identical with respect to the knobs, indicators, clip warnings, etc.

Price: Guitar Rig is 1GB and available for US\$ 199 at the Native Instruments website, from where it can be downloaded. Guitarix is available for free. Just go to <http://guitarix.org/> and download it. The site also provides links for downloading or buying additional cheap third party VSTs.

Flexibility: Guitar Rig is very versatile software. The pedal controller available in the market called Guitar Rig Kontrol gives artists the ability to shift between patches or adjust the volume on stage. Moreover, Guitar Rig, being more popular, has a lot of support from a large user base and hence, any bugs or queries are dealt with fairly quickly. And so, the frequency of updates and feature additions is also pretty high.

Guitarix lacks flexibility when compared to Guitar Rig. But it provides enough controls, just like those found in BOSS, VOX and the Zoom guitar multi-effects processors like compressors, various distortions, crunch, etc. **END** 🐧

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